

Xavier Ortiz Monasterio (1926–2011) took his Ph.D. in philosophy at the University of Paris and taught for thirty-four years at the University of Dayton. He is the author of *To Be Human: An Introductory Experiment in Philosophy* (Paulist Press, 1985) and of essays on Camus, Sartre, and the philosophy of faith. He worked on this book through the 1990s; it is published here for the first time.

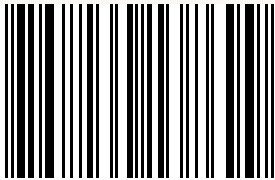
Edited by Jorge Monasterio.

The complete archive of the author’s papers is preserved at github.com/jmonasterio/xavier-omonasterio

PHILOSOPHY · RELIGION

“The Bible and the Summa are books of totally different literary genres. Nonetheless, supposedly, the subject matter of both is divine revelation. The question is whether in the shift from one genre to the other divine revelation remains the same — or whether, on the contrary, it undergoes a substantive change, a change affecting its very nature.”

— from Chapter 1



ISBN 979-8-234-13869-9

MONASTERIO

BELIEVING INTO GOD

MONASTERIO BOOKS

Believing into God

*Aquinas, Aristotle, and the
Denaturation of Christian Faith*

Xavier Ortiz Monasterio

Did Thomas Aquinas baptize Aristotle — or did Aristotle quietly denature Christian faith?

In this book, left unpublished at his death, Xavier Ortiz Monasterio argues that the medieval synthesis celebrated as the triumph of faith and reason in fact transformed faith into something the Church Fathers would not have recognized: assent to propositions rather than the whole person’s consent to God.

Reading Aquinas against Bonaventure, Anselm, and the resisters of the thirteenth century, Monasterio traces how the Bible — a fundamentally narrative book — was recast as a collection of statements fit for Aristotelian science, and what was lost in that translation. The argument anticipates Hans Frei’s “eclipse of biblical narrative” and grounds it a full five centuries earlier.

The manuscript’s final three chapters, reconstructed from the author’s notes, complete the argument as he projected it.

Jacket design: Monasterio Books